LST-P3 · PRÁCTICA 01

Interview or conversation

Hoja 01 · Entrevista con una invitada, opiniones explícitas · dificultad 1 de 4

5 preguntas (16–20) · 1 punto por pregunta · audio: LST-P3_Practica_01.mp3 · la grabación suena dos veces, con las pausas del examen · sin consultar la teoría

You will hear part of an interview with Clara Wainwright, a literary translator who translates novels from Swedish into English. For questions 16–20, choose the answer (**A, B, C** or **D**) which fits best according to what you hear.

16 What does Clara say about how she became a translator?

A It came about largely by chance.
B It was a natural next step after her university studies.
C A friend persuaded her to give up her career in music.
D She learnt Swedish because she wanted to translate from it.

17 What is Clara's view of the idea that the best translation is one the reader does not notice?

A She thinks it matters more for crime fiction than for other kinds of novel.
B She has come to have doubts about it.
C She believes it is the only realistic goal for a translator.
D She feels it has led to translations that sound unnatural.

18 According to Clara, what is the most challenging aspect of translating from Swedish?

A finding English equivalents for specialised vocabulary
B explaining police procedures to English readers
C showing how close or distant characters are to one another
D deciding which Swedish words to leave untranslated

19 What concerns Clara about machine translation?

A It will soon translate novels as well as people can.
B Correcting its errors takes longer than translating from scratch.
C Publishers may use it as a way of paying translators less.
D Readers will stop caring whether a book has been translated well.

20 What advice does Clara give to people who want to become literary translators?

A Spend as long as possible in the country whose language they translate.
B Get into the habit of checking every unfamiliar word.
C Read the original aloud to get a feel for its rhythm.
D Concentrate on improving their writing in their own language.

Hoja de respuestas

Marca una sola letra por pregunta. Al corregir, 1 punto por acierto; los errores no restan. En el examen en papel se responde en el cuadernillo y al final hay 5 minutos para pasar las respuestas a la hoja.

Nº	A	B	C	D	Puntos
16	A	B	C	D	/ 1
17	A	B	C	D	/ 1
18	A	B	C	D	/ 1
19	A	B	C	D	/ 1
20	A	B	C	D	/ 1
				Total	**/ 5**

SOLUCIONES

1 punto por acierto. Primero la clave rápida; después, la transcripción completa con la frase que da cada respuesta en negrita y el número de la pregunta; por último, por qué la clave es correcta y por qué falla cada distractor, con su tipo (§4) y la cita que lo descarta. Los números de sección remiten a LST_Teoria_v1.

Clave rápida

Nº	Clave	Tipo de pregunta	Distractores	Teoría
16	**A**	Detalle	B §4.1 · C §4.5 · D §4.6	§7.1 · §3.1
17	**B**	Actitud y opinión	A §4.8 · C §4.4 · D §4.1/4.8	§3.3 · §3.2
18	**C**	Detalle	A §4.2 · B §4.1 · D §4.8	§2.3 · §4.2
19	**C**	Actitud y opinión	A §4.2 · B §4.3 · D §4.8	§2.3 · §4.3
20	**D**	Detalle	A §4.2 · B §4.1 · C §4.1/4.8	§3.3 · §4.2 · §7.2

Transcripción

You will hear part of an interview with Clara Wainwright, a literary translator who translates novels from Swedish into English.

Voces · Interviewer: Ryan, inglés británico · Clara: Sonia, inglés británico

Interviewer My guest today is Clara Wainwright, whose translations of Scandinavian crime fiction have sold millions of copies. Clara, did you always know you wanted to be a translator?

Clara I'd love to say it was a calling, but honestly, **I drifted into it** [16]. I'd studied music, of all things, and I went to Stockholm for a year to play in an orchestra. I picked up the language because I had to, and when a friend at a publishing house needed someone to read a Swedish novel and tell her whether it was any good, **I happened to be the only person she knew who could** [16]. I wrote a report, she asked me to translate a sample chapter, and that was that. Twenty years later, here I am.

Interviewer People often say that the best translation is one you don't notice – that the reader should forget the book was ever written in another language. Is that what you aim for?

Clara It's what I was taught to aim for, and **I'm less and less sure about it** [17]. Of course the English has to read naturally – nobody wants clumsy sentences. But if a novel is set in a small town in the north of Sweden, I don't think the reader should come away feeling it might as well have been set in Yorkshire. Something of the original ought to show through. **So no, I don't want to be invisible.** [17] I'd rather readers knew that someone had made choices on their behalf.

Interviewer And which choices are the hardest? I imagine all those different words for snow…

Clara Everyone imagines that! But vocabulary is the easy part – that's what dictionaries are for. **What really keeps me awake is the way people speak to each other** [18]. In Sweden, almost everyone uses first names and the informal word for 'you', whether they're talking to a child or to the prime minister. English doesn't work like that. So when a young police officer chats to her boss as if he were her brother, an English reader might think she's being rude, when in Swedish it's perfectly ordinary. **I spend hours finding other ways to show how close or distant the characters are.** [18]

Interviewer Machine translation has improved enormously in the last few years. Does it worry you?

Clara	Not in the way you might think. I tried it once for a first draft, and I spent longer untangling the result than it would have taken me to start from scratch. For novels, I really don't believe the machines are going to replace us. **What does worry me is that some publishers may start handing translators machine output**[19] and calling the job 'editing' – at half the fee. That would be bad for translators, but it would also be bad for books.
Interviewer	Finally, what would you say to someone who'd like to do what you do?
Clara	Most people expect me to say 'go and live abroad', and living in Sweden certainly helped me, I won't deny it. But the mistake I see most often isn't poor Swedish – it's flat, awkward English. Your readers will never see the original; all they'll ever see is your writing. **So read as widely as you can in your own language, and write every day.**[20] You can always look up a word. You can't look up a sense of rhythm.

Explicaciones

16 · A · Detalle

Pregunta: What does Clara say about how she became a translator?

A It came about largely by chance.
Correcta. Lo dice al principio, I drifted into it, y lo confirma la anécdota: la amiga necesitaba a alguien que leyera sueco y I happened to be the only person she knew who could. «Por casualidad» resume las dos frases sin repetir ninguna palabra.

B It was a natural next step after her university studies.
Falla (eco léxico §4.1). Recoge I'd studied music, pero lo que estudió no tenía nada que ver con la traducción, y ella misma lo subraya: of all things.

C A friend persuaded her to give up her career in music.
Falla (grado y alcance §4.5). La amiga solo le pidió un informe sobre una novela (tell her whether it was any good). Nadie la convence de dejar la música.

D She learnt Swedish because she wanted to translate from it.
Falla (lógica alterada §4.6). Invierte el orden: aprendió sueco por necesidad, mientras tocaba en la orquesta (I picked up the language because I had to), y la traducción llegó después.

Teoría: §7.1 Part 3: la tarea · §3.1 Lo que se dice y lo que se da a entender

17 · B · Actitud y opinión

Pregunta: What is Clara's view of the idea that the best translation is one the reader does not notice?

A She thinks it matters more for crime fiction than for other kinds of novel.
Falla (ausente §4.8). La novela negra solo aparece cuando el entrevistador la presenta. Clara no compara géneros en ningún momento.

B She has come to have doubts about it.
Correcta. Es lo que le enseñaron, pero I'm less and less sure about it, y lo cierra sin ambigüedad: So no, I don't want to be invisible. La duda ha ido creciendo con los años: has come to.

C She believes it is the only realistic goal for a translator.
Falla (voz equivocada §4.4). Es lo que le enseñaron (It's what I was taught to aim for), no lo que piensa ahora.

D She feels it has led to translations that sound unnatural.
Falla (eco léxico §4.1, ausente §4.8). Recoge la idea de naturalidad (the English has to read naturally), pero Clara la da por supuesta. No culpa a la invisibilidad de ninguna traducción poco natural.

Teoría: §3.3 La segunda idea manda · §3.2 Voz propia y voces ajenas

18 · C · Detalle

Pregunta: According to Clara, what is the most challenging aspect of translating from Swedish?

A finding English equivalents for specialised vocabulary
Falla (mencionado y descartado §4.2). Lo menciona el entrevistador y ella lo descarta: vocabulary is the easy part.

B explaining police procedures to English readers
Falla (eco léxico §4.1). La policía aparece solo en el ejemplo (a young police officer chats to her boss), que trata de cómo se hablan, no de procedimientos.

C showing how close or distant characters are to one another
Correcta. La señal What really keeps me awake is (§2.3) anuncia la respuesta: el trato entre los personajes. Lo resume al final: I spend hours finding other ways to show how close or distant the characters are.

D deciding which Swedish words to leave untranslated
Falla (ausente §4.8). Encaja con su idea de que Something of the original ought to show through, pero nunca habla de dejar palabras en sueco.

Teoría: §2.3 Señales del discurso oral · §4.2 Mencionado y descartado

19 · C · Actitud y opinión

Pregunta: What concerns Clara about machine translation?

A It will soon translate novels as well as people can.
Falla (mencionado y descartado §4.2). Lo descarta: I really don't believe the machines are going to replace us.

B Correcting its errors takes longer than translating from scratch.
Falla (no responde §4.3). Es cierto según su experiencia (I spent longer untangling the result), pero lo cuenta para explicar por qué la máquina no la preocupa como rival. No responde a qué le preocupa.

C Publishers may use it as a way of paying translators less.
Correcta. La señal What does worry me is da la respuesta: los editores podrían entregar a los traductores texto de máquina y llamarlo revisión, at half the fee.

D Readers will stop caring whether a book has been translated well.
Falla (ausente §4.8). Dice que sería malo for books, no que los lectores vayan a dejar de valorar una buena traducción.

Teoría: §2.3 Señales del discurso oral · §4.3 Cierto, pero no responde

20 · D · Detalle

Pregunta: What advice does Clara give to people who want to become literary translators?

A Spend as long as possible in the country whose language they translate.
Falla (mencionado y descartado §4.2). Lo concede (living in Sweden certainly helped me, I won't deny it) y lo deja de lado con But: no es su consejo.

B Get into the habit of checking every unfamiliar word.
Falla (eco léxico §4.1). Recoge You can always look up a word, que dice justo lo contrario: buscar palabras es lo fácil.

C Read the original aloud to get a feel for its rhythm.
Falla (eco léxico §4.1, ausente §4.8). Sale de a sense of rhythm, pero ese ritmo es el de la prosa inglesa del traductor. Nunca propone leer el original en voz alta.

D Concentrate on improving their writing in their own language.
Correcta. El error que más ve es flat, awkward English, y el consejo va a lo mismo: So read as widely as you can in your own language, and write every day.

Teoría: §3.3 La segunda idea manda · §4.2 Mencionado y descartado · §7.2 Part 3: método